

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: 1. Anatomy of a morally appraised action

CENTRAL FOCUS

1. Anatomy of a morally appraised action

[1] Start with the situation, relevant facts and realistic alternatives.

|
v

[2] Identify motive: the background reason moving the agent.

|
v

[3] Identify intention: the result and means deliberately chosen.

|
v

[4] Test the chosen means for duty, dignity and legality.

|
v

[5] Estimate expected and reasonably foreseeable consequences.

|
v

[6] Record actual consequences without equating outcome with complete responsibility.

|
v

[7] Separate what was controlled from resultant or circumstantial luck.

|
v

[8] Triangulate duty, consequence and character into a reasoned verdict.

|
v

VERDICT -> Never let a good motive or fortunate outcome substitute for appraisal of intention and means.

ANSWER USE -> Use as the opening diagnostic in any theory question or administrative case study.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: 2. Deontological duty ladder

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2. Deontological duty ladder

[1] Good will asks whether the agent acts from duty rather than expediency.

|
v

[2] State the operative maxim behind the proposed administrative act.

|
v

[3] Universalise the maxim and test for contradiction or selective privilege.

|
v

[4] Apply the humanity formula: never treat persons merely as means.

|
v

[5] Identify the duty and rights floor that outcomes cannot ordinarily override.

|
v

[6] Recognise agent-relative restraints on one's own lying, coercion or falsification.

|
v

[7] Where duties conflict, identify their grounds instead of mechanically repeating rules.

|
v

[8] Give a reasoned priority while acknowledging deontology's rigidity limit.

|
v

VERDICT -> Deontology supplies non-negotiable floors, but hard cases still require reasoned priority among duties.

ANSWER USE -> Use to write the duty-and-rights paragraph in a Mains answer or case evaluation.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: 3. Consequentialist outcome calculus

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3. Consequentialist outcome calculus

[1] List feasible alternatives rather than comparing action only with inaction.

|
v

[2] Map every materially affected stakeholder, including weak and future interests.

|
v

[3] Estimate expected benefits under each alternative.

|
v

[4] Estimate direct, indirect and opportunity-cost harms.

|
v

[5] Attach realistic probabilities and identify uncertainty.

|
v

[6] Examine distribution and the short, medium and long time horizons.

|
v

[7] Include precedent, institutional trust and behavioural incentives.

|
v

[8] Select the best expected outcome subject to an explicit rights check.

|
v

VERDICT -> A utility total is credible only when stakeholders, uncertainty, distribution and long-term trust are visible.

ANSWER USE -> Use for policy appraisal, cost-benefit ethics and option comparison in case studies.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: 4. Act utility versus rule utility

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4. Act utility versus rule utility

[1] Act utilitarianism treats the individual act as the unit of evaluation.

|
v

[2] Rule utilitarianism evaluates the general acceptance of a rule.

|
v

[3] Act utility asks whether a local exception improves expected welfare.

|
v

[4] Rule utility asks what widespread exception-making would produce.

|
v

[5] General rules create predictability and administrative coordination.

|
v

[6] Impartial rules protect trust and reduce disguised favouritism.

|
v

[7] Rigid adherence can become rule worship when context defeats purpose.

|
v

[8] Allow only authorised, recorded and reviewable purposive exceptions.

|
v

VERDICT -> Use welfare-promoting rules as the default and narrow purposive exceptions as the safety valve.

ANSWER USE -> Use to differentiate the two theories or analyse procurement and emergency departures.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: 5. Virtue ethics and phronesis wheel

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5. Virtue ethics and phronesis wheel

[1] Eudaimonia supplies the wider idea of human flourishing.

|
v

[2] Character concerns the kind of person repeated choices create.

|
v

[3] Habituation converts isolated good acts into reliable dispositions.

|
v

[4] The mean is appropriate response between excess and deficiency.

|
v

[5] Phronesis perceives which features of the context ethically matter.

|
v

[6] Public role and entrusted power shape the virtues demanded.

|
v

[7] Justice, courage, honesty, compassion and temperance must work together.

|
v

[8] Practical wisdom supplements rather than abolishes rules and evidence.

|
v

VERDICT -> Virtue ethics explains the quality of judgment that rules and calculations alone cannot supply.

ANSWER USE -> Use for wisdom, leadership, context-sensitive judgment and role-ethics answers.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: 6. Intuition-to-reason reflective loop

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6. Intuition-to-reason reflective loop

[1] An intuitive reaction first signals that something may be morally salient.

|
v

[2] Experience and affect explain its speed and practical sensitivity.

|
v

[3] Bias, familiarity and in-group preference make intuition fallible.

|
v

[4] Pause before converting the felt response into official action.

|
v

[5] Gather facts, alternatives, law and affected-party perspectives.

|
v

[6] Test the reaction through duties, consequences and virtues.

|
v

[7] State public reasons capable of review and appeal.

|
v

[8] Revise the intuition or decision when the reasoned test requires it.

|
v

VERDICT -> Intuition should trigger inquiry; reason should audit it; neither is sufficient alone.

ANSWER USE -> Use directly for 2023 Q4(b) and in the reasoning stage of any case study.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: 7. Doing good beyond the rulebook

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7. Doing good beyond the rulebook

[1] Specify the public good the proposed initiative seeks.

|
v

[2] Confirm delegated authority to take the proposed action.

|
v

[3] Check for an express statutory or regulatory prohibition.

|
v

[4] Check purpose and structure for an implied prohibition.

|
v

[5] Protect rights, due process and equal treatment of comparable citizens.

|
v

[6] Examine resource diversion, precedent and institutional capacity.

|
v

[7] Record reasons, apply consistently and preserve review.

|
v

[8] Proceed only as calibrated initiative rather than personal benevolence.

|
v

VERDICT -> No express prohibition is only the first gate, not a complete ethical or legal permission.

ANSWER USE -> Use as the full safeguard sequence for 2018 Q4(a) and discretion questions.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: 8. Means-and-ends ethical matrix

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8. Means-and-ends ethical matrix

[1] Good end with good means is the strongest presumptive choice.

|
v

[2] Good end with wrongful means creates the central disputed case.

|
v

[3] Wrongful end cannot be rescued by procedurally proper means.

|
v

[4] Wrongful end with wrongful means is rejected by every lens.

|
v

[5] Kantian duty imposes dignity and universalisability restraints.

|
v

[6] Act and rule consequentialism may assess exceptions differently.

|
v

[7] Gandhian and virtue reasoning ask what tainted methods create.

|
v

[8] Final synthesis: rights floor, then necessity and proportionality.

|
v

VERDICT -> Optimise consequences within clean means; justify emergency departures narrowly
rather than sloganising ends.

ANSWER USE -> Use for 2018 Q4(b), whistleblowing, surveillance and emergency-power answers.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: 9. Scarce-resource triage funnel

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9. Scarce-resource triage funnel

[1] Define the scarcity, time pressure and divisible resource.

|
v

[2] Map patients, workers, families and institutional stakeholders.

|
v

[3] Use reliable clinical or need-based evidence.

|
v

[4] Estimate aggregate welfare and avoid preventable waste.

|
v

[5] Protect equal worth and prohibit status-based discrimination.

|
v

[6] Examine vulnerability and indirect barriers faced by weaker groups.

|
v

[7] Publish criteria, document choices and provide rapid review.

|
v

[8] Adopt a consequence-sensitive but rights-constrained hybrid decision.

|
v

VERDICT -> Clinical benefit may guide priority, but it cannot convert social status into a measure of human worth.

ANSWER USE -> Use for health, disaster-relief and other scarce-resource allocation cases.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: 10. Snowden-type disclosure ladder

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10. Snowden-type disclosure ladder

[1] Identify the legal and professional duty of confidentiality.

|
v

[2] Identify privacy, public interest and democratic-accountability claims.

|
v

[3] Examine the discloser's motive without treating it as decisive.

|
v

[4] Examine intended audience, scope and chosen disclosure method.

|
v

[5] Compare public benefits with security, privacy and trust harms.

|
v

[6] Ask whether protected internal and oversight channels were viable.

|
v

[7] Apply necessity, minimisation and proportionality to the material released.

|
v

[8] Require accountability and an independently reviewable final verdict.

|
v

VERDICT -> Ethical defensibility turns on targeted, necessary and accountable disclosure, not moral motive alone.

ANSWER USE -> Use for whistleblowing, secrecy-versus-conscience and public-interest disclosure questions.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: 11. Moral luck taxonomy and vigilance test

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11. Moral luck taxonomy and vigilance test

[1] Control principle: blame should track what the agent could control.

|
v

[2] Resultant luck concerns how a decision actually turns out.

|
v

[3] Circumstantial luck concerns the situations an agent happens to face.

|
v

[4] Constitutive luck concerns temperament and capacities not wholly chosen.

|
v

[5] Causal luck concerns the antecedent causal chain shaping choice.

|
v

[6] Evaluate authority, evidence, diligence and foreseeable risk ex ante.

|
v

[7] Use outcomes as evidence and feedback, not the sole measure of blame.

|
v

[8] Apply the ARC-style bona-fides distinction without excusing negligence.

|
v

VERDICT -> Protect sound good-faith judgment from hindsight bias while preserving liability for bad process.

ANSWER USE -> Use for failed projects, vigilance scrutiny, disaster command and the 2019 honest-officials case.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: 12. Context-relative justice review cycle

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12. Context-relative justice review cycle

[1] Begin with stable constitutional and ethical values.

|
v

[2] Identify changed facts, technology, knowledge or institutional capacity.

|
v

[3] Identify changed burdens, beneficiaries and patterns of exclusion.

|
v

[4] Ask whether the old application now produces injustice.

|
v

[5] Reject convenience-based relativism and preserve core rights.

|
v

[6] Prefer lawful substance over mechanical attachment to literal form.

|
v

[7] Confirm authority, record reasons and provide appeal or review.

|
v

[8] Continue scrutiny, including of evolving AI-assisted decisions.

|
v

VERDICT -> Justice can require adaptive application without surrendering stable values or
legality.

ANSWER USE -> Use directly for 2024 Q4 and as the current-affairs bridge to AI governance.